Benefits Front-Desk Map

> **The one rule: you may assist. You never certify to VA.**

WHO IS THIS?

1 · "Which benefit am I on?"

Ask: "Do you have a VA counselor for Veteran Readiness and Employment?" or for the COE or award letter.

GI Bill or DEA:

GI Bill: the SCO certifies. Go to line 3 for what they file · Want the chapters explained? Hand them Which Benefit Am I On → *School Certifying Official (SCO)*

VR&E · Chapter 31:

Chapter 31: the counselor's lane. Plan, books, monthly money → their VR&E counselor · The school's certification → the SCO → *The student's VR&E counselor (VRC), School Certifying Official (SCO)*

They don't know:

Find it before anything else. Student checks online with their own sign-in · Or the COE / award letter, or VA's call center · The SCO can also look it up → *VA Education Call Center, School Certifying Official (SCO)*

2 · "Do I qualify for VR&E?"

Veteran (discharged), or still on active duty?

Veteran:

Discharge other than dishonorable AND a VA rating of 10% or more?

Both:

They may apply. The counselor decides. Apply on va.gov with VA Form 28-1900 · Route the conversation to a VRC → *The student's VR&E counselor (VRC)*

Not both, or not sure:

A VSO first. Hand them to an accredited VSO → *An accredited Veterans Service Officer (VSO)*

Active duty:

Do they have a VA disability rating yet?

Yes, a VA rating:

They may apply on VA Form 28-1900. Apply on va.gov · The VRC decides entitlement → *The student's VR&E counselor (VRC)*

No rating yet:

VA Form 28-0588, but only on VA's three routes. In the PEB process, in IDES, or expecting an other than dishonorable discharge with a VA memorandum rating of 20% or more? · None of those? Don't tell them they can apply → *The student's VR&E counselor (VRC), An accredited Veterans Service Officer (VSO)*

Not sure which applies:

The counselor decides. Hand the facts to a VRC → *The student's VR&E counselor (VRC), An accredited Veterans Service Officer (VSO)*

GETTING PAID

3 · "I registered. How do I get certified and paid?"

Which benefit?

GI Bill or DEA:

First term here, or did something change?

Yes: new, or something changed:

Veterans Clearance Form, with the COE attached. Submit after registering · Tell them first-time processing takes 30–45 business days · Chapter 35 student? Ask the SCO if the form is needed → *School Certifying Official (SCO)*

No: continuing, unchanged:

The SCO says whether a form is due. Ask the SCO: is a new form due this term? · Active duty, MEM Ashore, or a certificate program? Mention it → *School Certifying Official (SCO)*

VR&E · Chapter 31:

Nothing for the student to submit. Ask the SCO whether the counselor's authorization arrived · Not arrived → the student contacts their counselor → *School Certifying Official (SCO), The student's VR&E counselor (VRC)*

They don't know:

Find it before anything else. Student checks online with their own sign-in · Or the COE / award letter, or VA's call center · The SCO can also look it up → *VA Education Call Center, School Certifying Official (SCO)*

4 · “I haven’t been paid.”

Check 1 · Ask the SCO: has this term been certified?

Yes:

Check 2 · Does the certification match their real schedule?

Yes:

Check 3 · Which benefit?

GI Bill or DEA:

Check 4 · Have they verified with VA this month?

Yes:

School’s part is done. It’s VA’s clock. Payment: 7–10 business days after verifying · Housing pays at the end of the month it covers · Past that clock → the student asks VA → *VA Education Call Center, Ask VA, in writing*

No, or not sure:

Verify due: the student verifies. Online, by text, email or phone → *VA Education Call Center*

VR&E · Chapter 31:

Chapter 31: the counselor answers. Route the payment question to their VRC → *The student’s VR&E counselor (VRC)*

No:

Certified wrong: the SCO amends it. The SCO amends it in Enrollment Manager → *School Certifying Official (SCO)*

No:

Not certified: school-side, fix it today. Tell the student plainly what’s missing · Fix the missing piece today → *School Certifying Official (SCO)*

5 · “Am I full time?” · “How much will I get?”

Which chapter?

Chapter 33 (Post-9/11, Fry):

Hand them the planner, and say two things. “More than half time” · “At least one class in person” · Full time at ODU: 12 undergrad / 9 grad → *School Certifying Official (SCO)*

Chapter 31 (VR&E):

Training time by band. Don’t name a band. The SCO gives the full-time standard · Then the planner, with that standard · The counselor’s plan governs → *School Certifying Official (SCO), The student’s VR&E counselor (VRC)*

Chapter 30, 1606 or 35:

Monthly rate by band. The SCO certifies the band · Rates by band are on Which Benefit Am I On → *School Certifying Official (SCO)*

6 · “Does this class count as in person?”

Remedial, deficiency or developmental class?

Yes:

Straight to the SCO. Write down the course number and send it → *School Certifying Official (SCO)*

No:

Required on campus at any point during the term?

Yes:

In residence. The SCO certifies it as in residence → *School Certifying Official (SCO)*

No:

Distance learning. Post-9/11: an all-online term pays the online rate · Other chapters have no online rate → *School Certifying Official (SCO)*

Not sure:

Write it down for the SCO. Send the class and how it meets → *School Certifying Official (SCO)*

7 · Half time or below, asking about monthly money

Which chapter?

Chapter 33:

No housing at 50% or below. Exactly half time is not “more than half” · Tuition and fees are still paid → *School Certifying Official (SCO)*

Chapter 31:

Does VA have reduced work tolerance or an extended evaluation plan on file?

Yes:

VA pays per the counselor’s plan. Route to the counselor → *The student’s VR&E counselor (VRC)*

No, or not sure:

Below half: not payable. Exceptions are VA’s. Route to the counselor; don’t answer yes or no → *The student’s VR&E counselor (VRC)*

Chapter 30, 1606 or 35:

Below half time the chapters differ. Chapters 30 and 35: capped at tuition and fees · Chapter 1606: VA’s table has a below-half row → *School Certifying Official (SCO)*

CHANGES

8 · “I want to drop a class” · “I’m withdrawing”

Chapter 31?

Yes, VR&E:

The counselor decides plan changes. Tell the SCO; the student calls the VRC → *School Certifying Official (SCO), The student’s VR&E counselor (VRC)*

No, GI Bill or DEA:

Has the class started?

Not yet:

Never attended. Tell the SCO today. Certified already? The SCO amends it · Paid on already? The SCO reviews for a debt → *School Certifying Official (SCO)*

Yes:

Still inside add/drop for that session?

Yes:

A reduction. The SCO gives the date. Tell the SCO the day it happens · No books debt; housing debt is possible · No money plans until the SCO reports it → *School Certifying Official (SCO)*

No, past add/drop:

Stop. SCO before the drop, not after. Benefits can go back to day one · Reasons in writing go to the SCO · Last day to withdraw → *School Certifying Official (SCO)*

9 · “Can I switch benefits?”

Is the term already under way?

Yes:

Not mid-term. Into Chapter 31: next term, set up by the VRC · Between GI Bill chapters: next enrollment period → *The student’s VR&E counselor (VRC), School Certifying Official (SCO)*

No:

A VRC and the SCO conversation. VR&E doesn’t deduct from the GI Bill · GI Bill benefits cap at 48 months combined · MGIB and Post-9/11? Never say an election is final → *The student’s VR&E counselor (VRC), School Certifying Official (SCO)*

10 · “How much benefit do I have left?”

Which benefit were they awarded?

GI Bill, DEA or transferred:

Does VA’s online check work for them?

Yes, or haven’t tried:

Self-service, on their own device. va.gov remaining-benefits page, their own sign-in

Won’t show, undecided, or disputed:

The SCO reads Enrollment Manager. Hand it to the SCO · A dispute or undecided claim is VA’s → *School Certifying Official (SCO), VA Education Call Center, Ask VA, in writing*

Chapter 31:

The counselor has VR&E months. Route to the VRC → *The student’s VR&E counselor (VRC)*

PAPERWORK IN THE INBOX

11 · A Chapter 31 training authorization email

Are you the designated SCO?

No:

Forward it now and confirm they saw it. Forward to the SCO · Confirm they have it, not just “I forwarded it” · Old email? Say when it arrived → *School Certifying Official (SCO)*

Yes:

Permission, not proof of enrollment. Check registration and courses against it · Certify the enrollment in Enrollment Manager · Anything doesn’t match → line 12 → *School Certifying Official (SCO)*

12 · A Chapter 31 authorization doesn’t match

Is the mismatch written down and with the SCO?

Not yet:

Write it down, hand it over. Write exactly what doesn’t match · The SCO contacts the case manager on it → *School Certifying Official (SCO)*

Yes:

Nothing more from the desk. Tell the student the school asked the counselor’s office → *School Certifying Official (SCO), The student’s VR&E counselor (VRC)*

13 · Someone asks you to certify

Are you a designated SCO with VA’s training?

No:

You never certify. Assistant access from an SCO? You may enter data · No access? Gather the paperwork, hand it over → *School Certifying Official (SCO)*

Yes:

Certify the verified enrollment. From the registration record, not the paper handed over · Keep the supporting documentation → *School Certifying Official (SCO)*

14 · Someone wants to call Tungsten or the Financial Services Center

A student’s monthly money, or the school’s tuition invoice?

The student’s money:

Stop the call: wrong pipeline. Tungsten is VA’s vendor invoicing · Use line 4 instead → *School Certifying Official (SCO), VA Education Call Center*

The school’s invoice:

The SCO’s or the business office’s lane. Route it there → *School Certifying Official (SCO), ODU business office*

Every answer’s sources and contact details are on the page itself, at the address below.

A student in crisis, or worried about a Veteran? **Dial 988, then press 1**, or text 838255 — the Veterans Crisis Line, free and confidential, 24/7 (veteranscrisisline.net).

Not an official VA document and not a VA decision. It routes a question to the right step and the right role. The School Certifying Official's certification and VA's award govern a case; the VR&E counselor governs anything Chapter 31. Every answer carries its source and that source's date.

Student-facing pages: the kit's front door · Semester Pay Planner · Which Benefit Am I On.

Public address of this page: ferrelldevin.github.io/veteran-resources/education/odu-benefits-kit/desk/

BW-07 Benefits Front-Desk Map · revision 53 · prepared 2026-10-14 · Selection, arrangement and editorial content © 2026 Devin Ferrell, produced with AI assistance.
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